NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Change Management Process

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Document Control

Field	Value
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Table of Contents

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1. Introduction

The Change Management Process establishes a standardized approach for planning, evaluating, approving, implementing, and reviewing changes to NovaDesk applications, infrastructure, databases, and supporting services.

The objective is to minimize operational risk while enabling controlled delivery of business and technical improvements.

This document aligns with organizational governance standards and supports service reliability through consistent change execution.

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2. Purpose

The objectives of Change Management are to:

- Minimize service disruption.
- Reduce implementation risk.
- Improve change success rates.
- Ensure appropriate technical review.
- Protect production stability.
- Standardize implementation procedures.
- Maintain complete audit records.
- Support regulatory and operational compliance.

Every production change should follow the approved Change Management process unless emergency procedures apply.

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3. Scope

This process applies to planned changes affecting:

- Applications
- APIs
- Databases
- Kubernetes clusters
- Infrastructure
- Networking
- Security configurations
- Monitoring systems
- Logging platforms

- CI/CD pipelines
- Cloud resources
- Operating systems

Routine service requests and incident response activities are managed through separate operational processes.

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4. Change Definition

A change is any planned addition, modification, or removal of an IT service, infrastructure component, configuration item, or operational process that may affect business services.

Examples include:

- Software deployments
- Database schema changes
- Infrastructure upgrades
- Kubernetes configuration updates
- Firewall rule modifications
- SSL certificate replacement
- Application configuration changes
- Operating system patching
- DNS updates
- Monitoring configuration changes

Every production change must be recorded in the Change Management System.

Configuration Items (CIs)

Changes may affect one or more Configuration Items.

Examples include:

- Application services
- Databases
- Virtual machines
- Kubernetes clusters
- Load balancers
- Network devices

- Storage systems
- Security appliances

Configuration Items are tracked within the Configuration Management Database (CMDB).

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5. Change Categories

NovaTech classifies changes according to risk, complexity, and urgency.

Standard Change

Standard Changes are:

- Low risk
- Frequently performed
- Pre-approved
- Well documented
- Repeatable

Examples:

- Routine certificate renewal
- Scheduled operating system patching
- Approved monitoring updates
- Routine log rotation configuration

Standard Changes follow predefined implementation procedures.

Normal Change

Normal Changes require formal review and approval before implementation.

Characteristics:

- Moderate or high risk
- Business impact assessment required
- CAB review (where applicable)
- Testing required

Examples:

- New feature deployment

- Database schema modification
- Infrastructure upgrades
- Network architecture changes

Normal Changes represent the majority of production changes.

Emergency Change

Emergency Changes address urgent situations requiring immediate implementation.

Examples:

- Critical security vulnerability
- Production outage recovery
- Emergency infrastructure repair
- Urgent certificate replacement
- Active security incident mitigation

Emergency Changes require expedited approval and mandatory post-implementation review.

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6. Roles and Responsibilities

Successful change management requires clearly defined responsibilities.

Change Requester

Responsible for:

- Preparing the Change Request.
- Documenting implementation details.
- Performing impact assessment.
- Defining rollback procedures.
- Coordinating testing.

Change Manager

Responsible for:

- Reviewing Change Requests.
- Coordinating approvals.

- Scheduling implementation.
- Monitoring execution.
- Confirming documentation completeness.

The Change Manager oversees the entire change lifecycle.

Change Advisory Board (CAB)

The CAB reviews significant Normal Changes.

Responsibilities include:

- Technical evaluation.
- Business impact assessment.
- Risk review.
- Approval recommendations.
- Scheduling guidance.

The CAB should include representatives from multiple technical and business areas.

Platform Engineering

Responsible for:

- Infrastructure implementation.
- Kubernetes configuration.
- Deployment execution.
- Technical validation.
- Rollback support.

Database Administration

Responsible for:

- Database changes.
- Schema updates.
- Data migration.
- Backup verification.
- Restore support.

Information Security

Reviews changes affecting:

- Authentication
- Authorization
- Encryption
- Firewalls
- Network security
- Compliance

Security approval is mandatory for changes impacting security controls.

Business Owner

The Business Owner:

- Confirms business justification.
- Reviews customer impact.
- Approves planned downtime (where applicable).
- Validates business readiness.

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7. Change Lifecycle Overview

Every change follows a standardized lifecycle.

Request

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Assessment

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Risk Analysis

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Approval

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Planning

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Testing

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Implementation

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Validation

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Closure

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Post-Implementation Review

Each stage should be documented within the Change Management System.

Change Status Values

Standard change states include:

Status	Description
Draft	Request created
Submitted	Awaiting review
Under Review	Technical evaluation in progress
Approved	Ready for implementation
Scheduled	Implementation date assigned
In Progress	Change being implemented
Validation	Post-implementation verification
Completed	Successfully implemented
Closed	Documentation finalized
Cancelled	Change withdrawn

Status updates should be recorded throughout the lifecycle.

Change Record

Each Change Request should include:

- Change ID
- Requester
- Business justification
- Change category
- Risk level
- Impact assessment
- Affected Configuration Items
- Planned implementation window
- Rollback plan
- Testing evidence
- Approval history
- Implementation results
- Closure notes

Complete records support operational governance and auditing.

Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	January 2024	Initial Change Management Process
1.5	July 2025	Added Standard and Emergency Change Categories
2.0	January 2026	Updated Roles, Lifecycle, and Governance Requirements

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8. Change Request Process

All planned production changes begin with a formal Change Request (CR).

The Change Request should be submitted sufficiently in advance to allow technical review, testing, and approval.

Change Request Information

Each Change Request should include:

- Change title
- Business justification
- Change category
- Planned implementation date
- Expected duration
- Affected services
- Configuration Items (CIs)
- Risk assessment
- Business impact
- Rollback plan
- Testing evidence
- Implementation steps

Incomplete requests may be returned for revision.

Change Submission Timeline

Change Type	Minimum Submission Time
Standard	2 Business Days
Normal	5 Business Days
Emergency	Immediately after emergency identification

The Change Manager may approve exceptions when operationally justified.

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9. Risk Assessment

Every Normal and Emergency Change requires a documented risk assessment.

Risk Evaluation

Risk assessment considers:

- Business impact
- Technical complexity
- Service availability
- Customer impact
- Security implications
- Recovery complexity
- Dependency changes

Risk should be evaluated before implementation approval.

Risk Levels

Risk Level	Description
Low	Minimal business impact and proven implementation
Medium	Moderate operational impact requiring coordination
High	Significant business or technical risk requiring extensive review

High-risk changes may require executive approval depending on organizational policy.

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10. Impact Analysis

Impact analysis identifies systems and stakeholders affected by the proposed change.

Areas to Evaluate

The analysis should consider:

- Customer-facing services
- Internal applications
- Databases
- Infrastructure
- Network connectivity
- Security controls
- Reporting systems
- Third-party integrations

Dependencies should be documented before implementation.

Business Impact

Business impact assessment includes:

- Expected service interruption
- Number of affected users
- Business criticality
- Planned maintenance window
- Customer communication requirements

Changes with significant business impact should be scheduled outside peak business hours whenever possible.

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11. Change Advisory Board (CAB)

The Change Advisory Board (CAB) reviews significant Normal Changes before implementation.

CAB Responsibilities

The CAB evaluates:

- Business justification
- Technical feasibility

- Risk assessment
- Implementation plan
- Rollback strategy
- Testing evidence
- Scheduling conflicts

Recommendations are documented within the Change Management System.

CAB Membership

Typical CAB participants include:

- Change Manager
- Platform Engineering Lead
- Application Support Lead
- Database Administrator
- Information Security Representative
- Business Owner
- Service Delivery Manager

Additional specialists may participate based on the proposed change.

CAB Outcomes

Following review, the CAB may:

- Approve the change
- Approve with conditions
- Request additional information
- Reject the change
- Defer implementation

All decisions should be documented.

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12. Approval Workflow

Changes require approvals appropriate to their category and risk level.

Standard Changes

Pre-approved through documented procedures.

No additional approval is required when all prerequisites are satisfied.

Normal Changes

Require approval from:

- Change Manager
- Technical Owner
- Business Owner
- Information Security (where applicable)

CAB approval is required for significant or high-risk changes.

Emergency Changes

Emergency Changes require expedited approval from:

- Incident Manager
- Change Manager
- Technical Lead

Formal documentation must be completed after implementation if operational urgency prevents prior completion.

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13. Implementation Planning

Implementation planning reduces execution risk and improves predictability.

Implementation Plan

The implementation plan should define:

- Objectives
- Start time
- End time
- Responsible personnel
- Detailed implementation steps
- Validation activities

- Rollback criteria
- Communication checkpoints

Plans should be reviewed before execution.

Maintenance Windows

Production changes should normally occur during approved maintenance windows.

Maintenance windows are selected to minimize customer impact.

Business stakeholders should be informed in advance of planned service interruptions.

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14. Testing Requirements

Testing provides confidence that the change will function as expected.

Required Testing

The following testing may be required:

- Unit testing
- Integration testing
- Regression testing
- Security testing
- Performance testing
- User Acceptance Testing (UAT)

Testing requirements depend on change category and risk.

Evidence

Testing documentation should include:

- Test environment
- Test scenarios
- Expected results
- Actual results
- Known limitations
- Approval to proceed

Evidence is attached to the Change Request.

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15. Rollback Planning

Every production change should include a documented rollback strategy.

Rollback Criteria

Rollback should be considered when:

- Service availability is significantly affected.
- Validation fails.
- Critical defects are identified.
- Security risks emerge.
- Customer impact exceeds acceptable thresholds.

Rollback decisions should prioritize business continuity.

Rollback Plan

A rollback plan should define:

- Trigger conditions
- Responsible personnel
- Recovery steps
- Estimated rollback duration
- Validation activities
- Communication actions

Rollback procedures should be tested whenever practical.

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16. Communication Procedures

Effective communication reduces uncertainty during planned changes.

Internal Communication

Stakeholders should receive:

- Change summary

- Planned implementation time
- Expected impact
- Service interruption details
- Rollback information
- Completion confirmation

Updates should follow the approved communication schedule.

Customer Communication

Where customer impact is expected, notifications should include:

- Planned maintenance window
- Affected services
- Expected duration
- Customer actions (if any)
- Contact information

Customer communications should be approved before distribution.

Completion Notification

After successful implementation, stakeholders receive confirmation including:

- Implementation outcome
- Validation status
- Service availability
- Outstanding issues (if any)

Completion notifications formally close the implementation phase.

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17. Implementation Best Practices

Implementation teams should:

- Follow approved implementation plans.
- Verify prerequisites before execution.
- Record implementation progress.
- Validate services immediately after deployment.

- Escalate unexpected issues promptly.
- Execute rollback procedures when required.
- Document deviations from the approved plan.
- Confirm successful completion with stakeholders.

Consistent execution improves change success rates and reduces operational risk.

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18. Implementation Validation

After implementation, the change must be validated to confirm that services are operating as expected.

Validation should occur before the change is marked as completed.

Validation Activities

The implementation team should verify:

- Application availability
- User authentication
- Database connectivity
- API functionality
- Scheduled jobs
- Monitoring dashboards
- Log collection
- Backup processes
- Customer-facing services

Validation results should be documented within the Change Management System.

Acceptance Criteria

A change is considered successful when:

- Planned objectives are achieved.
- No critical defects remain.
- Monitoring indicates normal operation.
- Customer services are functioning correctly.
- Required stakeholders approve completion.

If validation fails, rollback procedures should be considered immediately.

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19. Post-Implementation Review (PIR)

A Post-Implementation Review evaluates the effectiveness of completed changes.

Priority should be given to:

- High-risk changes
- Emergency Changes
- Changes with unexpected outcomes
- Changes resulting in incidents

Review Objectives

The review should determine:

- Was the change successful?
- Were implementation procedures followed?
- Were risks accurately assessed?
- Was communication effective?
- Was the rollback plan adequate?
- What improvements should be made?

The objective is continuous improvement rather than assigning blame.

Review Participants

The review may include:

- Change Manager
- Change Requester
- Platform Engineering
- Database Administration
- Application Support
- Information Security
- Business Owner

Additional technical specialists may participate when required.

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20. Emergency Change Governance

Emergency Changes require additional governance after implementation.

Documentation

The following should be completed as soon as practical after implementation:

- Complete Change Request
- Risk assessment
- Implementation summary
- Validation evidence
- Root cause (where applicable)
- Approval record

Incomplete documentation should be resolved promptly.

Review Requirements

Every Emergency Change should receive a retrospective review to determine:

- Whether emergency implementation was justified
- Whether earlier planning could have avoided the emergency
- Whether preventive improvements are required

Recommendations are tracked through the Change Management process.

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21. Change Metrics and KPIs

Operational metrics measure the effectiveness of Change Management.

Key Performance Indicators

The following metrics are monitored:

Metric	Description
Change Success Rate	Percentage of successfully completed changes
Failed Change Rate	Percentage requiring rollback or resulting in failure

Metric	Description
Emergency Change Rate	Percentage of emergency changes
Rollback Rate	Percentage of changes requiring rollback
Change Approval Time	Average approval duration
CAB Review Time	Average review duration
Implementation Duration	Average execution time
Change-Induced Incidents	Incidents caused by implemented changes

Metrics are reviewed monthly by the Change Management Office.

Management Reporting

Monthly reports summarize:

- Total changes
- Changes by category
- Success and failure rates
- Emergency Changes
- CAB activity
- Rollback statistics
- Operational recommendations

Reports support strategic planning and process improvement.

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22. Documentation Requirements

Complete documentation is required for every production change.

Required Records

Each completed Change Request should include:

- Change ID
- Business justification
- Risk assessment
- Impact analysis

- Implementation plan
- Test evidence
- Rollback plan
- Approval history
- Validation results
- Implementation timeline
- Closure summary

Documentation should accurately reflect the implemented change.

Audit Requirements

Operational audits review:

- Process compliance
- Approval records
- Implementation evidence
- Documentation completeness
- CAB decisions
- Validation results

Audit findings should be tracked until resolved.

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23. Continuous Improvement

The Change Management process is reviewed regularly to improve operational effectiveness.

Improvement Activities

Continuous improvement includes:

- Reviewing failed changes
- Improving implementation procedures
- Updating standard changes
- Enhancing testing practices
- Refining approval workflows
- Automating repetitive tasks

- Updating documentation
- Conducting periodic training

Lessons learned are incorporated into future operational processes.

Knowledge Sharing

Operational knowledge should be shared through:

- Engineering meetings
- Internal Knowledge Base
- Technical documentation
- Change Management training
- Operational workshops

Knowledge sharing improves implementation quality across teams.

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24. Compliance and Governance

Change Management supports organizational governance and audit readiness.

Governance Principles

The process should ensure:

- Clearly defined ownership
- Standardized procedures
- Appropriate approvals
- Risk management
- Auditability
- Continuous review

Governance responsibilities are shared across IT Operations, Platform Engineering, Information Security, and Business Owners.

Policy Compliance

Changes should comply with:

- Information Security Policy
- Infrastructure Standards

- Database Administration Standards
- Operational Procedures
- Regulatory requirements
- Internal audit requirements

Exceptions require documented approval.

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25. Operational Best Practices

Change implementation teams should:

- Plan thoroughly before implementation.
- Test changes in non-production environments.
- Maintain documented rollback procedures.
- Communicate planned changes proactively.
- Validate services after implementation.
- Monitor production closely after deployment.
- Complete documentation promptly.
- Review failed changes objectively.
- Reduce emergency changes through proactive planning.
- Continually improve implementation practices.

Operational consistency improves change reliability and customer satisfaction.

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26. Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. Which changes require a Post-Implementation Review?

High-risk, Emergency, and changes with unexpected outcomes or change-induced incidents.

Q2. When should rollback procedures be initiated?

Rollback should be considered whenever validation fails, critical defects are identified, or business impact exceeds acceptable limits.

Q3. What is the Change Success Rate?

The percentage of implemented changes completed successfully without requiring rollback or causing significant operational issues.

Q4. Are Emergency Changes exempt from documentation?

No. Documentation may be completed after implementation when operational urgency requires immediate action, but it remains mandatory.

Q5. Who reviews monthly Change Management metrics?

The Change Management Office reviews metrics with IT Operations and relevant stakeholders.

Q6. What documents are required for audit purposes?

Risk assessments, approvals, implementation plans, testing evidence, rollback plans, validation results, and closure records.

Q7. How can Emergency Changes be reduced?

By improving planning, scheduling routine maintenance, enhancing monitoring, and proactively addressing known risks.

Q8. What should happen after a failed change?

Investigate the failure, execute rollback if required, document findings, and implement corrective actions before rescheduling.

Q9. Why is continuous improvement important?

Continuous improvement strengthens operational processes, reduces implementation risk, and increases the overall success rate of production changes.

Q10. When is a Change Request officially closed?

After successful validation, completion of documentation, approval of closure, and recording of all required implementation evidence.

Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	January 2024	Initial Change Management Process
1.5	July 2025	Added CAB Governance and Emergency Change Procedures
2.0	January 2026	Added Validation, Post-Implementation Review, Operational Metrics, and Continuous Improvement

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Related Documents

- Incident Response Process (OPS-IR-001)
- Infrastructure Guide (TECH-INFRA-001)
- Database Backup Manual (TECH-DB-001)
- Developer Guide (TECH-DEV-001)
- Information Security Policy (COMP-SEC-003)
- Business Continuity Plan (OPS-BCP-002)
